

AI will redefine the MBA, not replace it

Technological adoption is accelerating much faster than meaningful pedagogical integration

BY **ABHISHEK AGRAWAL**

EVERY GENERATION OF management education has been reshaped by a defining disruption. The liberalisation era pushed business schools from domestic administration to global strategy. The internet boom democratised access to corporate information. The pandemic moved classrooms online almost overnight.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is different. Earlier disruptions changed where learning happened; generative AI and large language models—from ChatGPT and Gemini to Claude and enterprise AI agents—are changing how knowledge itself is created, analysed, and applied.

That raises a fundamental question for business school leaders: if AI can draft financial models, build marketing strategies, and interpret earnings transcripts in seconds, what should an MBA actually teach?

The answer is not to resist AI, but to redesign management education around distinctly human capabilities.

THE NEW REALITY

In the *Business Today*–MDRA Best B-Schools Survey 2026-27, responses from 277 management institutions across India, shows that AI has firmly entered the classroom through simulations, adaptive learning, research assistance, and industry projects. Yet it also reveals a widening gap: technological adoption is accelerating much faster than meaningful pedagogical integration.

Globally, leading institutions have already moved beyond debating whether AI belongs in management education. Harvard Business School has embedded AI into its curriculum through Data Science and AI for Leaders. Wharton offers a STEM-certified AI for Business major alongside enterprise AI access for MBA students. MIT Sloan, Stanford, Chicago Booth, and INSEAD are integrating AI directly into finance, operations, marketing, and strategy rather than treating it as a standalone technology elective.

Equally important is how these schools govern AI. Harvard requires applicants to disclose AI use, Kellogg enforces citation norms, and Wharton combines access with clear governance frameworks. The lesson is straightforward: prohibition is unrealistic; responsible integration is the only sustainable path.

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Recent research by GMAC, AACSB, and the Graduate Business Curriculum Roundtable reinforces this shift. Across leading business schools, AI is becoming part of teaching, research, administration, and faculty development—not an experimental add-on, but an institution-wide transformation.